

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; bile; metabolism; laboratory test; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The proposed image shows a full, asymmetrical liver with a domed major lobe, a tapering lesser lobe, a visible lobe seam, and an optional small gallbladder cue beneath the lower edge. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the broad lobed silhouette at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal relies on the direct literal meaning of the liver.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to create distinct messages:

- Liver + Test Tube or Bar Chart: a liver function test or result.
- Liver + Pill or Warning: medicine-related liver monitoring or a liver safety warning.
- Liver + Hospital or People: liver transplantation, donation, follow-up, or support.

These are established organ-specific contexts. MedlinePlus describes liver function tests, including their use in monitoring medicine effects, and NIDDK describes liver transplantation and living-donor transplantation.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

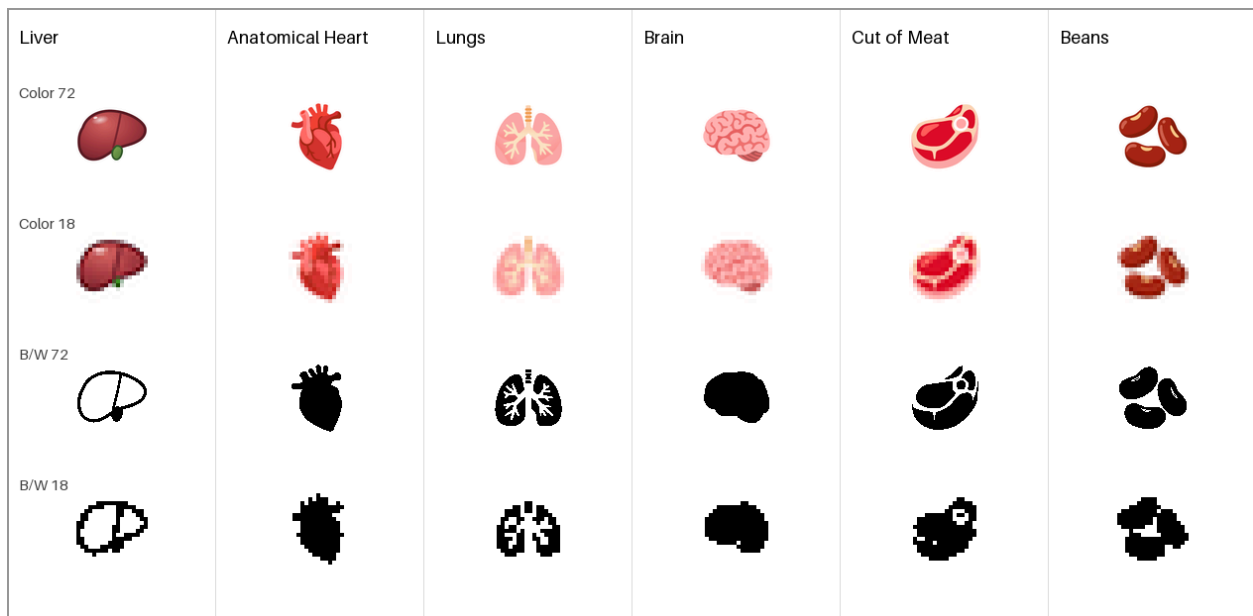
C. Breaks new ground

Yes. No current emoji or reliable emoji sequence identifies the liver. Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain identify different body parts; Cut of Meat and Beans do not reliably identify a liver; and general medical emoji can express testing, treatment, or care without supplying the missing body-site term. Liver therefore adds a direct way to identify the organ in ordinary messages.

Current Unicode emoji list: <https://www.unicode.org/emoji/charts/full-emoji-list.html>

D. Distinctiveness

The liver's broad, low, asymmetrical silhouette separates it from the taller Anatomical Heart, paired Lungs, and rounded Brain. Unequal lobes and a visible lobe seam remain present in both 18x18 versions; the color design adds an optional green gallbladder cue. Against the closest object confusers, the form is a single full organ rather than a food cut or a pair of seeds. The black-and-white design uses a white interior and strong outline instead of a featureless filled shape.



E. Expected usage level

Liver is used directly in general anatomy, laboratory testing, medication monitoring, transplantation, donation, food, and education. MedlinePlus maintains dedicated pages for liver diseases and liver function tests, while NIDDK maintains patient guidance dedicated to liver transplantation. The five frequency figures below measure the term directly; Google Trends and Google Books use Unicode's reference term `elephant` for comparison.

Sources:

- <https://medlineplus.gov/liverdiseases.html>
- <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/liver-function-tests/>
- <https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/liver-disease/liver-transplant>

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term liver .

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows a Google search interface for the term "liver". At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and the search bar contains "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are icons for settings, sharing, and a grid of apps, followed by a blue "Sign in" button.

Below the search bar is a horizontal menu with tabs: "All", "Images", "Shopping", "Videos", "Forums", "Short videos", "More", and "Tools". The "Tools" tab is selected, and a dropdown menu is open showing options: "Any time", "All results", "Advanced Search", and "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

The main content area is divided into two columns. The left column features an "AI Overview" section with a blue star icon. It contains a summary: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below this is a "Key Functions" section with a "Show more" button. The right column shows a "9 sites" carousel with a "Liver - Wikipedia" entry. The Wikipedia entry includes a thumbnail image of a liver and the text: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which..."

Below the carousel, the first search result is from Cleveland Clinic, titled "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy". The snippet reads: "Sep 26, 2025 — Your liver is located on the right side of your upper abdomen. Its functions include filtering blood, making chemicals and fighting ...".

Underneath is a "People also ask" section with four questions, each with a dropdown arrow: "What are the first signs of a bad liver?", "What is the best drink to flush your liver?", "How do I fix liver problems?", and "Where do you feel liver pain?".

The next search result is from Wikipedia, titled "Liver". The snippet reads: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism".

At the bottom, the "Images" tab is visible.

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and a search bar contains the word "liver". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are settings, grid, and a "Sign in" button. Below the search bar, navigation tabs include "All", "Images", "Books", "News", "Videos" (which is selected and underlined), "Shopping", and "More". To the right of these tabs is a "Tools" dropdown menu. The menu is open, showing options: "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". At the bottom of the menu, it says "About 72,400,000 results (0.20s)".

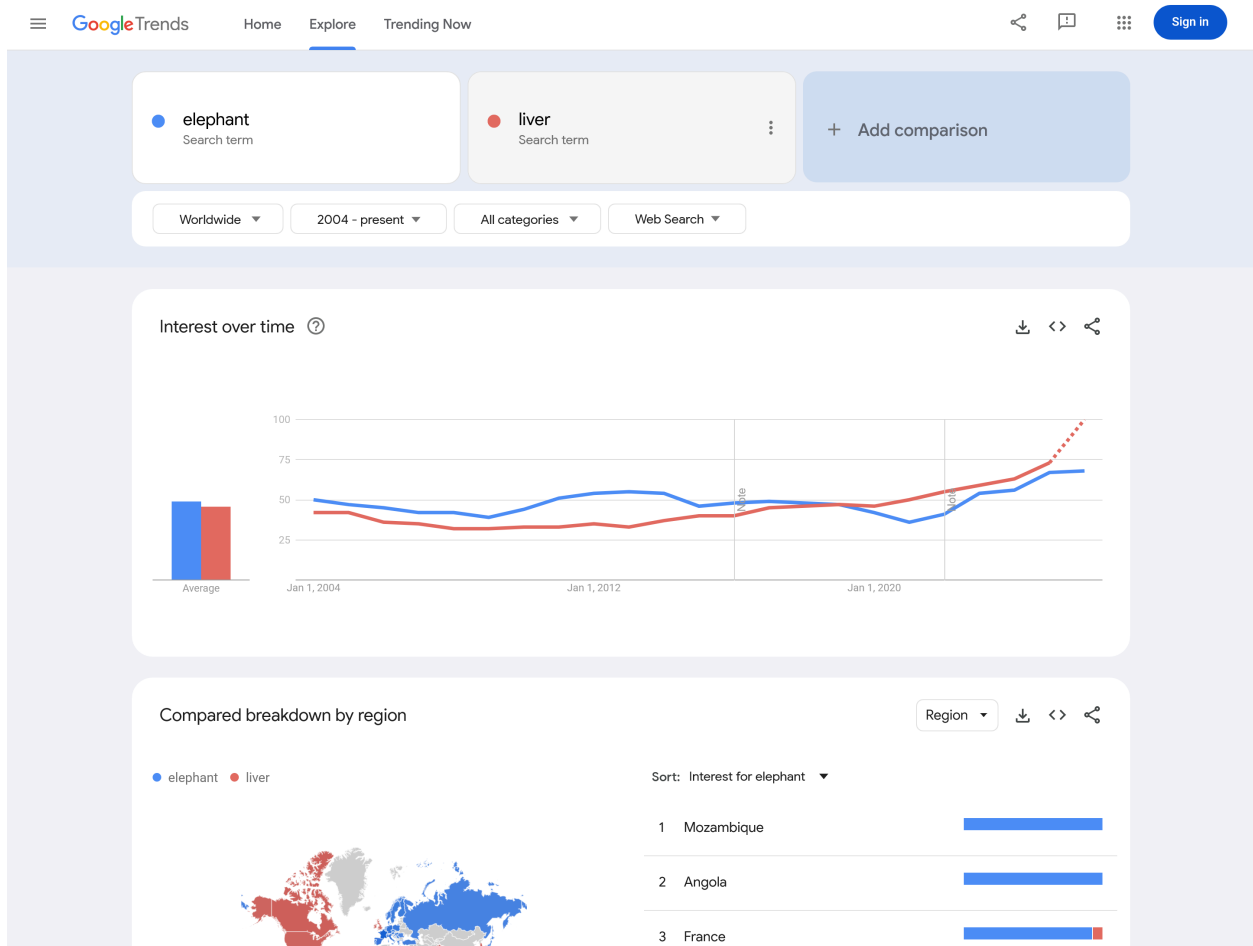
The search results are listed below the navigation tabs. Each result includes a thumbnail, a title, a description, and the source/channel name and upload date.

- How The Liver Works**
For more information about how the liver works
cle.clinic/4wVcJJE The liver is a large organ in
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024
4 key moments in this video
- Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains**
For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: <https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant> or ...
YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026
3 key moments in this video
- Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation**
the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and the
hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...
YouTube · Allila Medical Media · May 1, 2023
5 key moments in this video
- Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English**
At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors
(hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...
YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024
- Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...**
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms,

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

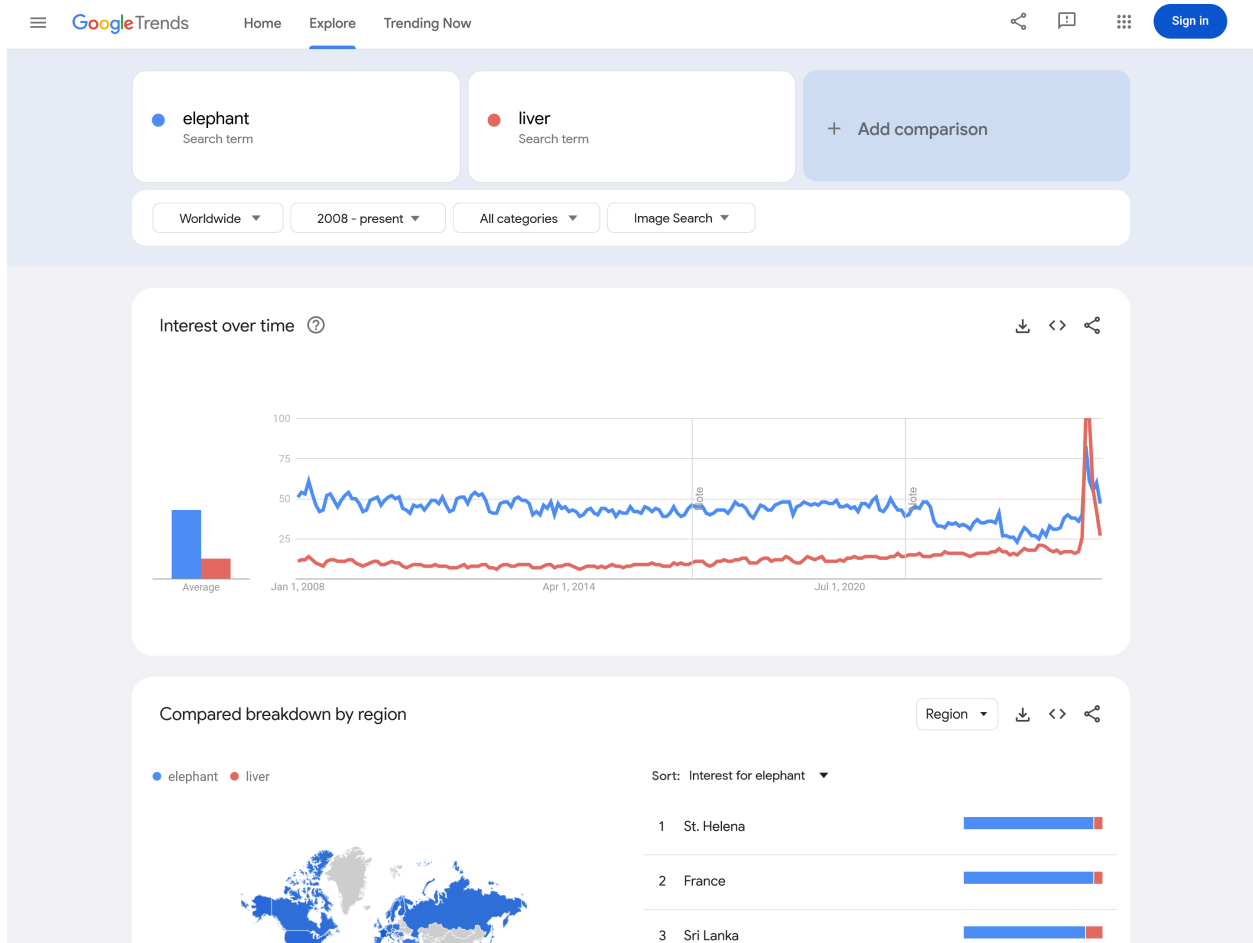
Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,liver>



Google Trends - Image Search

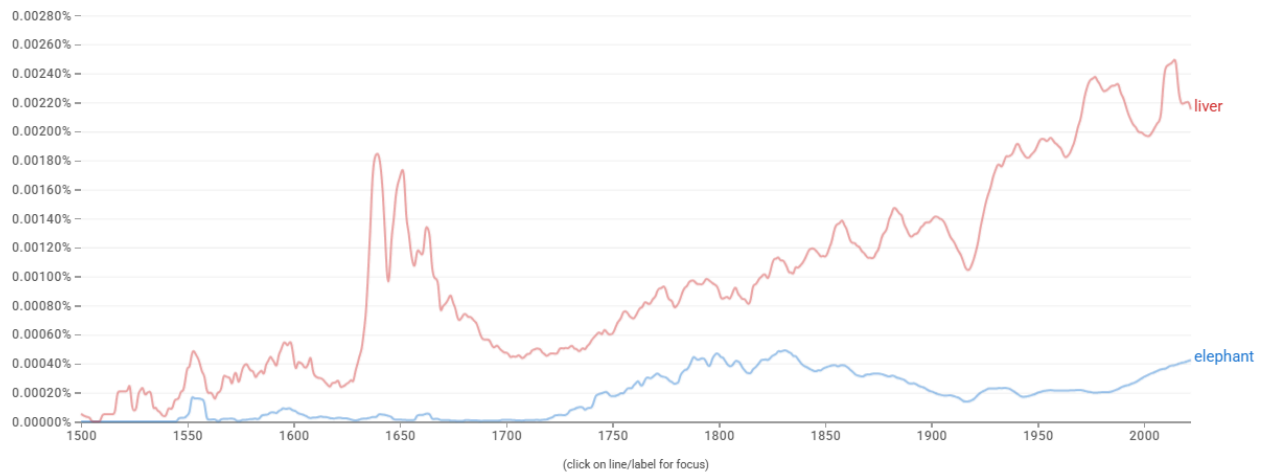
Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while showing sustained worldwide use throughout the period and a pronounced recent peak.

Reproducible query: https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,liver



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. Reproducible query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Liver is independently useful and is not proposed to complete an anatomy set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or a high-frequency pictograph in another system.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

The strongest substitute is a short sequence such as Hospital + Test Tube, but that sequence means medical testing generally and cannot identify which body site is being discussed. Cut of Meat and Beans are also ambiguous substitutes because they primarily encode food. No current emoji or short sequence supplies the literal liver term.

B. Overly specific

Liver is a broad anatomical entity used across everyday health, laboratory, transplant, donation, food, and education messages. It is not a disease, procedure, specialty, campaign, organization, or brand.

C. Open-ended

Liver is not proposed simply because it belongs to the category of organs. It has an independently documented combination of ordinary uses in liver testing, medication monitoring, transplantation and donation, anatomy education, and food, plus a compact asymmetrical lobed shape that remains distinct at 18x18. Those characteristics support this candidate only; they do not create a rule that other organs should be encoded.

D. Transient

Liver is a durable term rather than a temporary event or campaign. The embedded Ngram covers 1500-2022, and the current MedlinePlus and NIDDK resources document continuing laboratory and transplant uses.

E. Faulty comparison

The case does not depend on the existence, importance, or acceptance of another emoji. Existing anatomical emoji are used only as visual and semantic comparisons; Liver is supported by its own usage and its own expressive gap.

Other Information

Essential design cues are one broad asymmetrical silhouette, unequal lobes, and a lobe seam that remains visible at 18x18. A small gallbladder, shading, highlight, angle, and exact red-brown tone are optional vendor choices and must not carry the meaning alone. Vendors should avoid a generic rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>